
THE VENDETTA GAZETTE

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Print” • Two Cents (If You’re Still Alive to Pay)

★ TERRITORY GAINS THIS WEEK ★

Wu-Tang	+164 turfs
Claude	+42 turfs

THE CLOCKWORK CARNAGE OF WU-TANG CONTINUES UNABATED

*One Hundred and Sixty-Four More Turfs Devoured; Sir Caprice Reduced to a Rumour
and a Bad Memory*

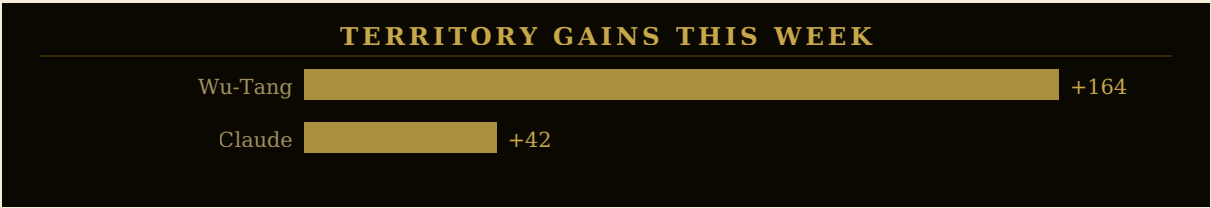
BY OUR MAN IN THE TRENCHES, IGNATIUS P. FLAMBEAU

Your correspondent had entertained — foolishly, he now confesses — the faint and rather charming hope that this edition might inaugurate a new chapter in the saga of Vendetta City. That perhaps, in the golden haze of a September week, some bold upstart might have planted his flag upon fresh soil and given this exhausted typewriter something novel to hammer out. Reader, no such mercy was forthcoming.

Wu-Tang, the Iron Fist of the East Side, has returned to the front page with the grim inevitability of a tax collector and roughly twice the menace. One hundred and sixty-four turfs seized from the crumbling dominion of the already-battered **Sir Caprice**, accompanied by no fewer than eighty-three separate raids upon that wretched soul's cashboxes and arsenals. This follows — your correspondent reminds you, lest your memory prove mercifully short — last week's savage reckoning of one hundred and sixty-six captures and an equal number of plunderings visited upon that same unfortunate personage. Sir Caprice, at this rate of territorial hemorrhage, shall soon possess nothing more than a hat, a grudge, and an increasingly theoretical headquarters.

What is most remarkable — and most terrifying — about Wu-Tang's campaign is not its ferocity alone, but its relentless *consistency*. Two weeks running. Same target. Same

method. Same result. This is not the work of an opportunist. This is the work of a man with a ledger, a plan, and an almost indecent fondness for punctuality.



CLAUDE THE CALCULATED MAKES HIS MOVE ON CHARLE REBORN

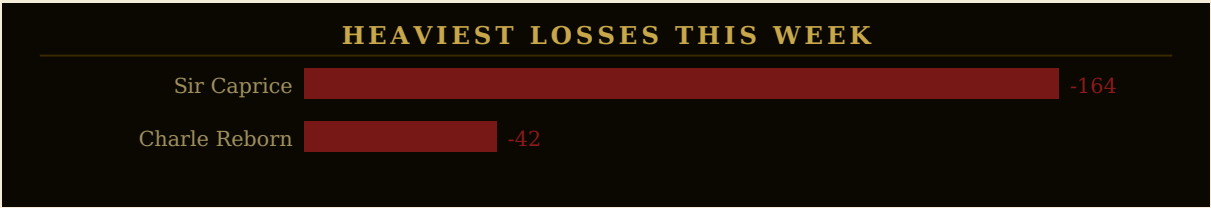
Forty-Two Turfs Captured; the Biggest Single Haul of the Week Nets Five Hundred Smackers

BY OUR SOCIETY CORRESPONDENT, MILLICENT VANE-ASHWORTH

Not content to lurk forever in the considerable shadow of Wu-Tang's conquests, **Claude** — whom the betting parlours of the South Ward have taken to calling "*Claude the Calculated*" — pressed his own territorial ambitions with admirable vim this week, annexing forty-two turfs from the faltering empire of **Charle Reborn**. The campaign was methodical, surgical, and accompanied by twenty-two raids upon Charle Reborn's dwindling reserves.

Most audaciously, Claude dispatched his finest enforcers upon the holdings of the notorious **Asiong Salonga**, extracting a tidy five hundred dollars in cash and five hundred units of arms in a single, magnificent swoop — the grandest individual raid logged in Vendetta City this entire week. Whether Asiong Salonga shall take this imposition lying down or retaliate in kind remains, at press time, an open and rather exciting question.

Claude's garrison, meanwhile, has swelled by a further seventeen souls, bringing his total standing army to a formidable fifteen hundred and twenty. The man is building, recruiting, and evidently sleeping very little. A dangerous combination in any borough.



★ SPECIAL BULLETIN: THE SILENCE THAT SPEAKS VOLUMES ★

This week, Vendetta City records precisely zero Headquarters captures — not a single boss dethroned, not a single flag torn from its standard. Whether this reflects an abundance of caution among the city's more aggressive operators, or merely the fact that Wu-Tang and Claude were too thoroughly occupied dismantling their chosen victims turf by turf to bother storming any fortified command posts, this correspondent cannot say with certainty. What he can say is that the absence of a fallen HQ feels less like peace and more like the held breath before a thunderclap. Vendetta City, do not grow comfortable.

FLATTOP RAISES AN ARMY WHILE OTHERS BLEED

Seven Hundred and Eighty-Two New Gangsters; the Man in the Flat Cap Prepares for Something